SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

22 July 2022 · Shift 3

60 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 40 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. In exactly the same words as were used originally

(A) Imprecise
(B) Strict
(C) Neutral
(D) Verbatim

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. He has been presented off honorary awards.

(A) No error
(B) presented off
(C) He has been
(D) honorable awards

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Invigorate

(A) Deform
(B) Energise
(C) Tire
(D) Grow

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Both songs have been reworked giving them fresh “impetus”.

(A) detachment
(B) aversion
(C) disfavour
(D) incitement

Q.5

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Waryness
(B) Monumental
(C) Disenchentment
(D) Awakning

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The weather was so _____ that she couldn’t step out of the house.

(A) serious
(B) inept
(C) terrible
(D) slight

Q.7

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. This is "on far a best" ice cream I have ever had.

(A) by far the best
(B) at farthest a good
(C) by far more better
(D) No improvement required

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Reveal

(A) Curb
(B) Veil
(C) Darken
(D) Disclose

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Get cold feet

(A) To get no results
(B) To be in a bad mood
(C) To feel nervous about doing something
(D) To escape from something

Q.10

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Water "is using in every" cell of your body.

(A) is used in every
(B) No improvement required
(C) using in each
(D) are used in every

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Gandhiji spent many years _____ Sabarmati Ashram.

(A) with
(B) by
(C) on
(D) at

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. After all the fuss, the companies "has still not reach" a consensus.

(A) have still not reached
(B) have still to reached
(C) had still not reach
(D) No improvement required

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Food was _____; guides were not to be found, and the enemy dogged them all the way.

(A) scarce
(B) crass
(C) chance
(D) farce

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Serene

(A) Unperturbed
(B) Pleased
(C) Composed
(D) Agitated

Q.15

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The Andes mountains / lay between / Chile and Argentina.

(A) Chile and Argentina
(B) lay between
(C) No error
(D) The Andes mountains

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My life has _____ meaning without you.

(A) not
(B) never
(C) no
(D) none

Q.17

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. There are some Indian herbs / that possesses a range / of important therapeutic properties.

(A) of important therapeutic properties
(B) that possesses a range
(C) No error
(D) There are some Indian herbs

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To blaze the trail

(A) To oppose all criticism
(B) To cause the failure of
(C) To start a movement
(D) To mark the end of the movement

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The prospects of surviving any serious illness are improved if the disease is "catching early."

(A) being caught early
(B) caught early
(C) No substitution required
(D) catch earlier

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nuclear power for civil use is well (1) _____ in India. Since building the two small boiling water reactors (2) _____ Tarapur in the 1960s, its civil nuclear strategy (3) _____ directed towards complete independence in the nuclear fuel cycle, necessarily (4) _____ it is excluded (5) _____ the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) implanted
(B) founded
(C) resurrected
(D) established

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nuclear power for civil use is well (1) _____ in India. Since building the two small boiling water reactors (2) _____ Tarapur in the 1960s, its civil nuclear strategy (3) _____ directed towards complete independence in the nuclear fuel cycle, necessarily (4) _____ it is excluded (5) _____ the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) at
(B) from
(C) on
(D) of

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nuclear power for civil use is well (1) _____ in India. Since building the two small boiling water reactors (2) _____ Tarapur in the 1960s, its civil nuclear strategy (3) _____ directed towards complete independence in the nuclear fuel cycle, necessarily (4) _____ it is excluded (5) _____ the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) have
(B) have been
(C) has been
(D) has

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nuclear power for civil use is well (1) _____ in India. Since building the two small boiling water reactors (2) _____ Tarapur in the 1960s, its civil nuclear strategy (3) _____ directed towards complete independence in the nuclear fuel cycle, necessarily (4) _____ it is excluded (5) _____ the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) though
(B) that
(C) because
(D) thus

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nuclear power for civil use is well (1) _____ in India. Since building the two small boiling water reactors (2) _____ Tarapur in the 1960s, its civil nuclear strategy (3) _____ directed towards complete independence in the nuclear fuel cycle, necessarily (4) _____ it is excluded (5) _____ the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT).

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) at
(B) within
(C) from
(D) of

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All G are R. II. Some F are G. Conclusions: I. All R are F. II. Some G are F. III. Some F are R.

(A) None of the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion III follows
(C) Only conclusions II and III follow
(D) All the conclusions follow

Q.2

In a certain code language, 'ACID' is written as 'ZBHC' and 'LAND' is written as ‘KZMC’. How will 'GOLD' be written in that language?

(A) FNKB
(B) FNKC
(C) FNJC
(D) FMKC

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. AND : VHV :: LXY : ?

(A) HRR
(B) HRQ
(C) GRQ
(D) GSQ

Q.5

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. MA, NZ, OY, PX, ?

(A) QV
(B) QW
(C) WQ
(D) QR

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'Fakes are not great' is written as '8 6 3 2' and 'Tall people are great' is written as '5 3 2 7'. Which one of the following is the possible code for 'not' in that code language?

(A) 8
(B) 3
(C) 2
(D) 5

Q.8

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 26 ÷ 24 + 6 × 27 – 105 = 29

(A) + and –
(B) ÷ and +
(C) + and ×
(D) ÷ and –

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. P 2 : R 4 :: D 5 : F 7 :: X 6 : ?

(A) Z 8
(B) Y 8
(C) Y 7
(D) Z 9

Q.11

There are five friends, Ram, Shekhar, Sonu, Rinku and Monu, who are sitting at different positions in a row and facing north. Two friends sit between Shekhar and Rinku. Shekhar sits neither in the first position nor the last position of the row. Monu is not an immediate neighbour of Shekhar. Ram sits second to the left of Sonu. Sonu does not sit at the extreme ends of the row. Who is sitting at the middle of the row?

(A) Sonu
(B) Ram
(C) Shekhar
(D) Monu

Q.12

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 2 + 78 ÷ 13 – 4 × 111 = 119

(A) + and ÷
(B) ÷ and ×
(C) + and –
(D) + and x

Q.13

Seven birds — A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting in a straight row, facing north. D sits third to the right of F, who sits at the second position from the left end. E sits between A and F. G sits to the left of F. B sits in the second position from the right end. Which of the following statements is true?

(A) B sits exactly between D and A.
(B) C sits at extreme right end.
(C) F sits at extreme left end.
(D) E sits to the immediate left of D.

Q.15

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (7, 1, 3); (12, 2, 5)

(A) (30, 8, 11)
(B) (26, 4, 20)
(C) (32, 6, 18)
(D) (40, 10, 30)

Q.17

In a certain code language, if Delhi is called Mumbai, Mumbai is called Jaipur, Jaipur is called Durgapur, Durgapur is called Chandigarh, and Chandigarh is called Jodhpur, then which city is the capital of Rajasthan?

(A) Durgapur
(B) Jaipur
(C) Chandigarh
(D) Mumbai

Q.18

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 24, 625, 26, 729, 28, 841, ?

(A) 961
(B) 900
(C) 29
(D) 30

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 59 : 14 :: 61 : 7 :: 37 : ?

(A) 12
(B) 6
(C) 8
(D) 10

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. LAM : AML :: RUK : ?

(A) KRU
(B) URK
(C) UKR
(D) KUR

Q.23

In certain code language, ‘DID’ is coded as ‘494’, ‘DEAR’ is coded as ‘4518’ and ‘BENT’ is coded as ‘2540’. How will ‘FOR’ be coded in that language?

(A) 668
(B) 557
(C) 567
(D) 658

Q.24

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All basketball players are tall people. Suman is tall. Conclusions: I. Suman is a basketball player. II. Some tall people are basketball players.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.25

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.

18, 36, 25, 50, 39, ?

(A) 72
(B) 76
(C) 74
(D) 78

General Awareness 18 questions

Q.2

Vikas has an income of ₹2.5 lakhs. Which of the following tax slabs of India is applicable for him?

(A) 0.2
(B) 0.1
(C) 0.05
(D) Nil

Q.3

Which of the following countries shares their land boundary with India?

(A) Bhutan
(B) Indonesia
(C) Vietnam
(D) Uzbekistan

Q.7

Who among the following athletes won India's first gold medal in Javelin Throw at the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Leander Paes
(B) Deepika Kumari
(C) Mary Kom
(D) Neeraj Chopra

Q.8

The maximum temperature of the day occurs generally:

(A) in the afternoon
(B) in the early morning
(C) at midnight
(D) in the evening

Q.9

Which of the following statements about Paramhansa Mandalis is INCORRECT?

(A) They were primarily interested in breaking caste rules.
(B) Its founders did not believe in God.
(C) It was founded in 1849 in Maharashtra.
(D) They also advocated for widow remarriage and women's education.

Q.10

The heart of a fish has _____ chambers.

(A) three
(B) five
(C) four
(D) two

Q.11

Pramod Sawant took the oath as the Chief Minister of which state in March 2022?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Goa
(C) Gujarat
(D) Karnataka

Q.13

Select the correct statement.

(A) There are only 2 basic components of a cell-cytoplasm and nucleus.
(B) The cytoplasm and nucleus are enclosed within the cell membrane, also called the plasma membrane.
(C) The membrane separates ribosomes and mitochondria of a cell.
(D) The plasma membrane does not allow inward movement of the substance.

Q.14
In India, primitive form of cultivation is known as ‘Jhumming’ in the _____.

(A) Western Ghats
(B) south-eastern region
(C) Himalayan belt
(D) north-eastern region

Q.15
Which country is separated from India by the Gulf of Mannar?

(A) Bangladesh
(B) Sri Lanka
(C) Indonesia
(D) China

Q.16
Which of the following laws states that with the temperature remaining constant, the volume of a given mass of a gas varies inversely with the pressure of the gas?

(A) Graham's Law
(B) Kepler's Law
(C) Charles's Law
(D) Boyle's Law

Q.18
Makar Sankranti is celebrated as the _____ long Pongal festival in Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh.

(A) seven-day
(B) two-day
(C) five-day
(D) four-day

Q.19
Which country hosted the ICC Women’s World Cup 2021/22?

(A) New Zealand
(B) Australia
(C) South Africa
(D) England

Q.20
In 1929, Indian National Congress demanded complete independence under the presidentship of _____.

(A) Dadabhai Naoroji
(B) Jawaharlal Nehru
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Chitta Ranjan Das

Q.22
Every judge of the Supreme Court in India shall hold office until he attains the age of _____ years.

(A) 55
(B) 65
(C) 58
(D) 62

Q.23
Which of the following novels was written by the famous Indian novelist Amrita Pritam?

(A) Midnight's Children
(B) Satya ke Prayog
(C) Raseedi Ticket
(D) Train to Pakistan

Q.24
In the Indian constitution, the Right to Freedom is covered from _____.

(A) Article 19 to 22
(B) Article 26 to 30
(C) Article 14 to 18
(D) Article 23 to 25

Q.25
The Janjira Fort is situated on a small island in the Arabian sea, off the coast of _____.

(A) Gujarat
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Kerala
(D) Karnataka

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**
Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Verbatim

'Verbatim' means in exactly the same words as the original, word for word. 'Imprecise' means inexact and 'neutral' impartial.

Q.2 · Answer (B) presented off

One is presented 'with' an award, not 'off' it: 'He has been presented with honorary awards.' The option 'honorable awards' misprints the sentence's 'honorary', but that part of the sentence is correct.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Tire

'Invigorate' means to fill with energy, so its opposite is 'tire'. 'Energise' is close to it in meaning.

Q.4 · Answer (D) incitement

'Impetus' is a force or stimulus that drives something on, and 'incitement', encouragement to act, is closest. 'Detachment', 'aversion' and 'disfavour' do not fit.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Monumental

'Monumental' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'wariness', 'disenchantment' and 'awakening'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) terrible

Weather bad enough to keep her indoors is 'terrible'. 'Inept' means unskilled, and 'serious' and 'slight' do not describe weather that way.

Q.7 · Answer (A) by far the best

'By far' strengthens a superlative, and a superlative takes 'the': 'This is by far the best ice cream I have ever had.'

Q.8 · Answer (D) Disclose

To 'reveal' is to make known: 'disclose'. 'Veil' and 'darken' suggest the opposite, hiding, and 'curb' means to restrain.

Q.9 · Answer (C) To feel nervous about doing something

To 'get cold feet' is to lose one's nerve: to feel nervous about doing something one had planned.

Q.10 · Answer (A) is used in every

Water does not use anything; it is used, so the passive is needed, with 'is' for the singular 'water': 'Water is used in every cell of your body.'

Q.11 · Answer (D) at

'At' marks a particular place, here the ashram where Gandhiji lived: 'spent many years at Sabarmati Ashram'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) have still not reached

The plural 'companies' takes 'have', and the perfect tense needs the past participle 'reached': 'the companies have still not reached a consensus'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) scarce

'Scarce' means in short supply, which fits a hard march without guides. 'Crass' means coarse or stupid, and 'chance' and 'farce' do not fit the sense.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Agitated

'Serene' means calm and peaceful, so its opposite is 'agitated'. 'Unperturbed' and 'composed' are close to it in meaning.

Q.15 · Answer (B) lay between

The verb for being situated is 'lie', in the present tense for a lasting fact: 'The Andes mountains lie between Chile and Argentina.' 'Lay' is its past tense, or a verb meaning to put down.

Q.16 · Answer (C) no
'No' goes before a noun to mean 'not any': 'My life has no meaning without you.' 'None' is a pronoun and cannot stand before a noun, and 'has not meaning' and 'has never meaning' are ungrammatical.

Q.17 · Answer (B) that possesses a range
'That' refers to the plural 'herbs', so the verb must be plural: 'herbs that possess a range of important therapeutic properties'.

Q.19 · Answer (C) To start a movement
SSC's key gives 'To start a movement': to blaze the trail is to be the first to do something new and lead the way for others, and of the options only starting a movement carries that sense of pioneering.

Q.20 · Answer (B) caught early
A disease does not catch anything; it is caught, so the passive is needed: 'if the disease is caught early'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) established
Nuclear power is 'well established', that is firmly set up and accepted, in India. 'Well founded' would mean justified, which does not suit the sense.

Q.22 · Answer (A) at
'At' goes before the particular place where the reactors were built: 'reactors at Tarapur'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) has been
'Since building the two small boiling water reactors ... in the 1960s' calls for the present perfect, the singular 'strategy' takes 'has', and the strategy is directed by others, so the passive: 'its civil nuclear strategy has been directed'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) because
The clause gives the reason for seeking independence in the fuel cycle: 'necessarily because it is excluded' from the treaty.

Q.25 · Answer (C) from
'Excluded' takes 'from': 'excluded from the 1970 Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) Only conclusions II and III follow
Some F are G and all G are R, so some F are R (III); 'some F are G' also means some G are F (II). Nothing makes every R an F, so I does not follow.

Q.2 · Answer (B) FNKC
Each letter moves one place back: ACID → ZBHC and LAND → KZMC. So GOLD → FNKC.

Q.3 · Answer (C) GRQ
The letters move back 5, 6 and 8 places, wrapping round after A: A → V, N → H and D → V. So L → G, X → R and Y → Q: GRQ.

Q.5 · Answer (B) QW
The first letters run M, N, O, P, Q and the second A, Z, Y, X, W, backwards from the end: QW.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 8
'Are' and 'great' occur in both sentences, so their codes are the shared 3 and 2. 'Not' is then 8 or 6, and only 8 is an option.

Q.8 · Answer (B) ÷ and +
After interchanging ÷ and +: 26 + 24 ÷ 6 × 27 − 105 = 26 + 108 − 105 = 29.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Z 8
The letter moves 2 places forward and the number rises by 2: P 2 → R 4 and D 5 → F 7. So X 6 → Z 8.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Sonu
Shekhar is not at an end and two sit between him and Rinku, so they are 2nd and 5th or 4th and 1st. With Shekhar 4th and Rinku 1st, Sonu (not at an end) would be 2nd or 3rd, leaving no free seat second to his left for Ram; with Shekhar 2nd and Rinku 5th, Sonu is 3rd, Ram 1st and Monu 4th, not next to Shekhar. Sonu sits in the middle.

Q.12 · Answer (D) + and x
After interchanging + and ×: 2 × 78 ÷ 13 − 4 + 111 = 12 − 4 + 111 = 119.

Q.13 · Answer (B) C sits at extreme right end.
F is 2nd from the left, so G, to its left, is 1st and D, third to its right, is 5th; B is 2nd from the right, 6th. E sits directly between A and F, so E is 3rd and A 4th, which leaves the right end for C: G F E A D B C.

Q.15 · Answer (A) (30, 8, 11)
In each set the first number is the second plus twice the third: 1 + 2 × 3 = 7 and 2 + 2 × 5 = 12. Likewise 8 + 2 × 11 = 30.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Durgapur
Jaipur is the capital of Rajasthan, and in this language Jaipur is called Durgapur.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 30
Two series alternate: 24, 26, 28 rise by 2, and 625, 729, 841 are 25^2, 27^2, 29^2. The next term is 30.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 10
The second number is the sum of the first number's digits: 5 + 9 = 14 and 6 + 1 = 7. So 3 + 7 = 10.

Q.22 · Answer (C) UKR
The first letter moves to the end: LAM → AML. So RUK → UKR.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 658
Each letter is coded as the last digit of its place in the alphabet: D(4) I(9) D(4) → 494, and R(18), N(14), T(20) → 8, 4, 0. So F(6) O(15) R(18) → 658.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows
Being tall does not make Suman a basketball player, so I does not follow. Since all basketball players are tall, some tall people are basketball players (II).

Q.25 · Answer (D) 78
The steps alternate ×2 and −11: 18 × 2 = 36, 36 − 11 = 25, 25 × 2 = 50, 50 − 11 = 39 and 39 × 2 = 78.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (D) Nil
Under both income tax regimes in force when the exam was held (July 2022), income up to ₹2.5 lakh fell in the nil slab, so no tax was due. The other options are the 20%, 10% and 5% rates of higher slabs, written as decimals.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Bhutan
Bhutan borders Sikkim, West Bengal, Assam and Arunachal Pradesh. Indonesia, Vietnam and Uzbekistan have no land border with India.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Neeraj Chopra
Neeraj Chopra won the javelin gold at Tokyo on 7 August 2021 with a throw of 87.58 m, India's first Olympic gold in athletics.

Q.8 · Answer (A) in the afternoon
The ground keeps gaining more heat from the sun than it loses until early afternoon, so the day's highest temperature usually comes around 2 p.m., not at noon when the sun is highest.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Its founders did not believe in God.
The Paramhansa Mandali, a secret society founded in Bombay by Dadoba Pandurang, Durgaram Mehtaji and others (in 1849 by most accounts), believed in one God. It worked mainly to break caste rules and also supported widow remarriage and women's education.

Q.10 · Answer (D) two
A fish heart has two chambers, one atrium and one ventricle, and pumps blood in a single circuit through the gills to the body.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Goa
Pramod Sawant was sworn in as Chief Minister of Goa for a second term on 28 March 2022, after the BJP emerged as the largest party, with 20 of the 40 seats, in the February 2022 Assembly election.

Q.13 · Answer (B) The cytoplasm and nucleus are enclosed within the cell membrane, also called the plasma membrane.
A cell has three basic parts, the cell membrane (plasma membrane), the cytoplasm and the nucleus, and the membrane encloses the other two. It separates the cell from its surroundings and lets substances pass both in and out.

Q.14 · Answer (D) north-eastern region
Slash-and-burn shifting cultivation is called 'jhumming' in the north-eastern states such as Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Nagaland.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Sri Lanka
The Gulf of Mannar lies between the south-east coast of Tamil Nadu and the west coast of Sri Lanka.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Boyle's Law
Boyle's law: at constant temperature, the volume of a fixed mass of gas is inversely proportional to its pressure. Charles's law relates volume to temperature at constant pressure, and Graham's law deals with rates of diffusion.

Q.18 · Answer (D) four-day
In Tamil Nadu Pongal is kept over four days in mid-January: Bhogi, Thai Pongal (the day of Makar Sankranti), Mattu Pongal and Kaanum Pongal.

Q.19 · Answer (A) New Zealand
New Zealand hosted the ICC Women's World Cup, put back from 2021 by the pandemic, from March to April 2022; Australia won it.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Jawaharlal Nehru
At its Lahore session in December 1929, presided over by Jawaharlal Nehru, the Congress adopted the resolution for Purna Swaraj, complete independence.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 65
Under Article 124(2) a Supreme Court judge holds office until the age of 65; High Court judges retire at 62.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Raseedi Ticket
'Raseedi Ticket' ('The Revenue Stamp') is by Amrita Pritam, though it is her autobiography rather than a novel. 'Midnight's Children' is by Salman Rushdie, 'Satya ke Prayog' is the Hindi title of Gandhi's autobiography and 'Train to Pakistan' is by Khushwant Singh.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Article 19 to 22
Articles 19 to 22 make up the Right to Freedom. Articles 14 to 18 are the Right to Equality, 23 and 24 the Right against Exploitation, and 25 to 28 the Right to Freedom of Religion.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Maharashtra
Murud-Janjira, the sea fort of the Siddis, stands on an island off Murud in Raigad district, Maharashtra.

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